Son Phan

Tech Lead · AWS Solutions Architect & DevOps

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SUMMARY

Tech lead and cloud engineer with 20+ years building software and over a decade leading teams of 6–15 engineers. Modernized a legacy .NET Framework 2.0 platform (~10M lines of code, tens of millions of users) to .NET 10, cutting deployments from 1 hour to 5 minutes. Architected a multi-tenant AWS SaaS built to scale to 2,000 tenants with cross-region disaster recovery, and now building a full ERP on a 9-month plan with an AI-native, spec-driven workflow. The go-to person for root-causing production hangs and memory leaks in .NET applications. Earned 8 AWS certifications, including Solutions Architect and DevOps Engineer – Professional.

SKILLS

Cloud architecture	Multi-tenant SaaS on AWS and GCP · Multi-AZ high availability · pilot-light cross-region DR (RTO 2 h, RPO 5 min) · auto-scaling on custom metrics · microservices
Networking & security	VPC design, 3-tier networks, Route 53, CloudFront, TLS · least-privilege IAM, per-environment AWS accounts, Secrets Manager, SSM Parameter Store · Security Hub, GuardDuty, Inspector
Infrastructure as code	AWS CDK, CloudFormation · multi-environment stacks (DEV/UAT/PROD), drift elimination, automated AMI baking
Containers & compute	Amazon ECS (Fargate, Fargate Spot), Amazon EKS, Docker, Docker Swarm, EC2 Auto Scaling, AWS Lambda
Release engineering	GitLab CI, Jenkins, AWS CodeBuild, ECR · blue/green deployments, rollback to the previous image in ~3 min, automated backup & restore
Observability & incidents	OpenTelemetry, CloudWatch, Sentry · root-causing .NET hangs and memory leaks with WinDbg, dotnet-dump, dotMemory
Cost optimization	Fargate Spot for background services, Lambda for small jobs, Auto Scaling sized to demand, AWS Well-Architected
Software & quality	.NET (Framework 2.0 → .NET 10), C#, Next.js, TypeScript, React, Angular, PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Redis, RabbitMQ · TDD, unit / integration / e2e testing
AI-assisted delivery	Claude Code, custom agent skills, spec-driven development (Spec Kit, OpenSpec, BMAD Method) · Bash and Python automation
Leadership	Hiring, mentoring, engineering culture, Git & development workflows, Agile (PMI-ACP)

EXPERIENCE

Lead Engineer, AI-Native Development · Alpha France Pharmacy — Freelance · Jun 2026 – Present

Greenfield ERP for a pharmacy business — HR, inventory, CRM, sales, KPIs and reporting — on a 9-month delivery plan and already in rollout, built with an AI-native, spec-driven workflow; requirements by a dedicated business analyst.

- Set up the project and engineering foundations on Next.js, TypeScript and PostgreSQL.
- Authored the AI "constitution" — the rules, conventions and guardrails coding agents follow — and drove delivery with Claude Code, custom agent skills and spec-driven frameworks (Spec Kit, OpenSpec, BMAD).
- Built the full test pyramid: unit, integration and end-to-end tests.
- Built CI/CD and deployed the system on Google Cloud Platform.

Senior AWS DevOps Engineer · Qredible, Inc. — Part-time · Jan 2022 – Jul 2026

Compliance-management SaaS for regulated industries. Owned both solution architecture and DevOps for a greenfield platform, working directly with the CTO.

- Proposed the architecture and built the entire AWS infrastructure for a multi-tenant SaaS designed to scale to 2,000 tenants (20 live), with strict tenant data isolation and a separate AWS account per environment (DEV, UAT, PROD).
- Designed for failure: Multi-AZ RDS/Aurora with read replicas, plus a pilot-light disaster-recovery setup with cross-region backups — RTO 2 hours, RPO 5 minutes.
- Shipped weekly with blue/green deployments; a bad release rolls back to the previous image in about 3 minutes.
- Matched cost to real demand while staying ready to scale 100×: Fargate Spot for background services, Lambda for small jobs, Auto Scaling sized to load and scaling on custom metrics (SQS queue depth, concurrent requests).

- Codified all infrastructure in AWS CDK and CloudFormation, eliminating configuration drift; ran workloads on ECS Fargate and EKS, built through AWS CodeBuild and ECR.
- Secured the platform with least-privilege IAM roles, Secrets Manager and SSM Parameter Store, a zero-trust VPC (private subnets, VPC endpoints, NACLs) and continuous compliance monitoring via Security Hub, GuardDuty, Inspector, AWS Config and CloudTrail.
- Built observability with OpenTelemetry and CloudWatch.

Nexcel Solutions

Mar 2010 – Jan 2026

High-traffic consumer platforms serving tens of millions of users — dozens of systems, ~10 million lines of code.

Team Leader, Senior Developer

Mar 2012 – Jan 2026

- Led the modernization of dozens of legacy systems from .NET Framework 2.0 to .NET 10 through continuous refactoring and framework upgrades.
- Replaced manual, lead-only releases (remote server login, manual backup/deploy/restore) with fully automated CI/CD — first on Jenkins, later migrated to GitLab CI — cutting each deployment from 1 hour to 5 minutes; every merged request now deploys automatically, with automated backup and easy restore.
- Go-to engineer for production incidents: tracked errors with Sentry and root-caused server hangs and memory leaks in .NET applications using WinDbg, dotnet-dump, dotMemory and profilers.
- Owned the company-wide shared libraries — data access (SQL Server, Redis), logging and messaging (RabbitMQ) — and the services enabling applications to run within a 3-tier network architecture.
- Grew an engineering culture of TDD and automated testing on a legacy codebase, with quality gates (static analysis, coverage, Robot Framework tests) on every commit.
- Ran workloads on Docker, Docker Swarm and Kubernetes, and built AWS infrastructure from scratch (VPC, EC2, Auto Scaling, ALB, CloudFormation, Route 53, CloudWatch).
- Led teams of 6–15 engineers: hiring, onboarding and training on Git, Clean Code, React, Angular, unit testing and CI; defined the development and Git workflows.

Software Developer

Mar 2010 – Mar 2012

- Built back-office features — customer settings, reporting and notifications — with ASP.NET MVC, JavaScript and jQuery.

Earlier career

2005 – 2009

- **Junior Silverlight Developer, Agile Mobile** (Dec 2008 – Dec 2009) — built a Silverlight web OS with messenger, office, photo and video apps.
- **COM+ Developer, TTNK Co.** (Jan 2005 – Jul 2008) — built COM+/ActiveX components for the business logic layer of a learning management system serving 300K users.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS certifications earned 2020–2023; all have since expired.

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional 2020
AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional 2020
AWS Certified Security – Specialty 2023
AWS Certified Advanced Networking – Specialty 2023
AWS Certified Database – Specialty 2023
AWS Certified Data Analytics – Specialty 2023
AWS Certified Machine Learning – Specialty 2020
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate 2020
PMI Agile Certified Practitioner (PMI-ACP) 2015
Claude Code in Action — Anthropic 2026

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science 2009
Ho Chi Minh City University of Technology

Engineer's Degree, Computer Science 2006
Ho Chi Minh City University of Technology

LANGUAGES

Vietnamese — native

English — professional working proficiency (TOEIC 915, Listening & Reading)